

Over 10m speeding violations in UAE in 2024

SHARJAH
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The UAE has released alarming traffic statistics for 2024, with over 10 million speeding violations caught by radars — close to the entire population of the country.

According to the Ministry of Interior (MoI), Abu Dhabi topped the list with over five million violations, followed by Dubai with more than two million, and Sharjah with over a million.

Other emirates recorded fewer offences.

Over five million drivers exceeded the speed limit by 20km/h, and more than four million exceeded it by up to 30km/h.

Despite strict penalties, including fines up to Dh3,000, traffic points, and vehicle impoundment, these violations remain rampant.

The ministry also highlighted negligence and inattention as primary causes of accidents, with reckless driving, running red lights, and unsafe overtaking being major contributors.

Sudden lane changes were responsible for 763 accidents, while distracted driving led to 732.

Speeding caused 82 accidents, with Abu Dhabi recording the highest toll, followed by Dubai and Sharjah.

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5 million

drivers exceeded the speed limit by 20km/h and over 4m exceeded it by up to 30km/h

Trump tariffs shock world, trigger market meltdown

OVER \$1.7 TRILLION WIPED OUT FROM TOP 500 US STOCKS YESTERDAY

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN GEORGE VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

President Donald Trump has imposed the toughest US tariffs in a century, intensifying trade tensions and rattling investors worldwide, sending shockwaves through the global economy and financial markets.

The new policy, announced on Wednesday, applies a minimum 10 per cent tariff on all foreign imports, with even steeper rates for over 60 nations, including major trade partners like China, the European Union, Japan, Vietnam, and India.

China, in particular, faces tariffs exceeding 50 per cent on several goods. “For too long, American workers have been sidelined while other countries gained at our expense,” Trump stated at the White House. “Now, it’s our turn to thrive.”

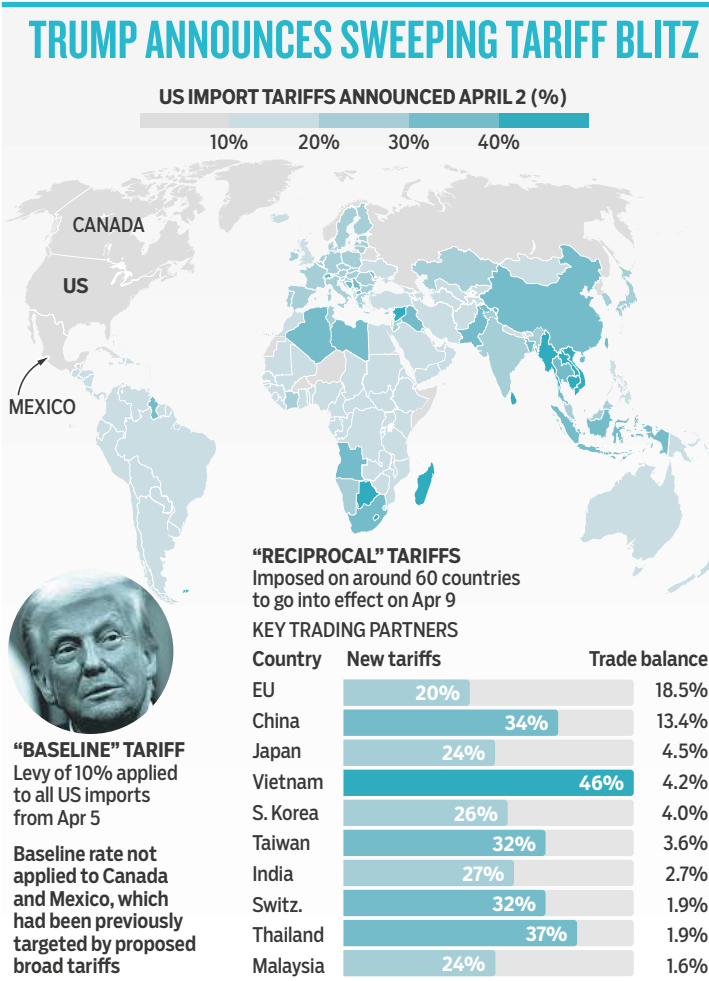
Dramatic escalation

This aggressive move is expected to provoke retaliation from affected nations, adding uncertainty to global markets. Experts warn that rising costs for businesses and consumers could slow economic growth or even trigger a recession.

Trump believes tariffs will strengthen American manufacturing and leverage better trade deals. However, many economists argue that trade barriers often backfire, leading to higher prices and weaker economic ties among nations.

The new tariffs will raise the effective tax rate on over \$3 trillion worth of imports to about 23 per cent, the highest level in more than a century.

This surpasses the protectionist policies of the 1930s,



Sources: White House, FT, BBC

Picture: Getty Images

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which contributed to economic downturns.

The “reciprocal tariffs” aim to match the barriers imposed by other countries on US exports, but they risk alienating allies and disrupting global supply chains.

Following the announcement, stock markets worldwide tumbled. US stocks plunged more than 3 per cent for second straight day, with \$1.7 trillion wiped out from the value of the

top 500 US stocks. Oil prices also dropped sharply.

Markets plunge

Investors are on edge, expecting countermeasures from affected nations. China vowed to respond and urged Washington to reconsider. Japan called the move “deeply regrettable” and suggested it could violate World Trade Organisation rules.

The European Union is preparing for countermeasures,

GCC frets over tariffs, oil prices

UAE investors grew anxious after Dubai's stock index tumbled yesterday, poised for its biggest daily decline this year. Other Gulf bourses slid after Trump's wide-ranging tariffs on importers.

Losers outnumbered gainers 34 to 10 on Dubai's benchmark, which was down as 1.8 per cent, due to Emaar Properties' steep 8.9 per cent drop, while Abu Dhabi's index slipped 0.8 per cent, signalling a regional downturn.

Saudi Arabia's main index fell 0.4 per cent after Eid, driven by losses from heavyweight firms like Saudi National Bank and oil giant Aramco. Qatar's stock exchange remains closed for the Eid holidays, delaying their market response.

Additionally, a 3 per cent decline in oil prices is adding to the region's financial strain. Analysts reminded investors to closely monitor tariff impact on key sectors.

but remains open to negotiations. Asian markets were hit hard as Chinese stocks slid.

Hong Kong index fell over 2.5 per cent before partially recovering. Tokyo stocks dropped 2.8 per cent, while markets in Sydney, Seoul, Manila, Mumbai, Shanghai, and Singapore also declined. Vietnam's stock exchange took the worst hit, plunging 7.8 per cent due to steep new tariffs.

— With inputs from Bloomberg
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